



United States Department of Transportation
Federal Aviation Administration

Alaska Automation Capability (AAC)
Statement of Objectives (SOO)

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Revision History for AAC Statement of Objectives (SOO)

Revision #	Description	Document Date
1	Draft Statement of Objectives - AAC	3/16/2026

1.0 INTRODUCTION

This Statement of Objectives (SOO) defines the Respondent requirements to provide a web-based cloud solution for the Alaska Automation Capability (AAC) project in support of Alaska flight services as part of the Department of Transportation (DOT) Brand New Air Traffic Control System (BNATCS).

1.1 Background

The Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) Flight Service primary role is to provide weather data, aeronautical information, and flight planning services to pilots. The FAA provides flight services to pilots through:

- a. Direct contact, by phone or radio, with a Certified Professional Controller (hereafter referred to as CPC) who translates weather and aeronautical data into critical and comprehensible information tailored for a particular flight.
- b. Online web portal providing Pilots access to weather and aeronautical data and the ability to file, activate, and close flight plans without speaking to a CPC.

Flight Service also supports disaster relief, medical evacuations, weather and traffic reporting, and business and personal travel to thousands of airports and landing areas. Military, law enforcement, commercial, corporate, Customs and Border Protection, and air taxi operators also benefit from services provided by Flight Service. Most users of un-controlled airspace are customers of Flight Service.

1.2 Purpose

The SOO details the FAA's goals and expectations for the modernization of the AAC automation system. The AAC effort will provide the means to modernize the existing or legacy Alaska Flight Service automation system to a web-based, cloud solution that provides upgraded technology enhancements to how FAA Flight Service provides support to the Alaska general aviation community. This SOO is issued as part of a Challenge-Based Acquisition (ChBA) focused on evaluating solutions for speed, safety, efficiency, and innovation.

The FAA faces a rapidly growing, complex, and demanding aviation sector, with commercial air travel returning to pre-COVID levels. In addition, there are new entrants in the National Airspace System (NAS), including drones, advanced air mobility, and commercial space. The air traffic control system is based on outdated technologies that are unable to meet these demands. The system is showing its age, which leads to delays and inefficiencies.

This ChBA for AAC seeks to transform Alaska Flight Service from its legacy client automation application system (referred to herein as the Operational and Supportability Implementation System-OASIS) to a modern, web-based system capable of meeting the demands of today and the future. The FAA plans to implement a new state-of-the-art automation system that will enhance the safety and efficiency of the Alaska airspace supported by FAA Flight Service.

1.3 Scope

AAC will address legacy Alaska Flight Service automation shortfalls while leveraging best practices and new technology to provide the Agency with a level of flexibility through a modernized web-based cloud system that is not currently available in the existing legacy system. Additionally, stakeholder-desired features and functionalities that are costly and time consuming to develop in the legacy system will be realized through this approach and allow for future growth and technological advances. The ultimate goal is to fully replace the legacy AAC automation solution as part of the BNATCS effort.

AAC will provide a foundation for efforts to achieve Flight Service goals such as:

- a. Provide consistent weather briefing and flight planning for Alaska general aviation pilots.
- b. Coordinate Search and Rescue (SAR) initiation and aircraft emergency activities.
- c. Provide aeronautical information services to Alaska pilots and air traffic controllers.
- d. Issue Notice to Airmen (NOTAM) providing essential information relating to the abnormal status of a component of the NAS.

Additionally, AAC seeks to leverage new and emerging technologies, where applicable, to meet the FAA's requirements.

2.0 PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE

The schedule below represents the FAA goals for this ChBA with resulting production award. Through this process, an integrated schedule that demonstrates deliveries in support of the Agency's goals will be developed.

Identified opportunities and risks associated with accelerating the AAC automation system deployment prior to the respective project completion dates are preferred by the FAA.

Milestone Activity ¹	Anticipated Schedule
Phase 1 Challenge 1 - Concept Papers	Q3 FY26
Phase 1 Challenge 2 - Demonstration/Oral Presentations	Q3 FY26
Phase 2 - Challenge - Prototype	Q3 FY26
Phase 3 - Follow-on Production Vehicle	Q4 FY26
Initial Operating Capability (IOC)	Q4 FY27

The FAA anticipates work to be performed at both government-site and remote locations; to be finalized upon production award. See Attachment 4, AAC Sites List.

¹ All milestones are target objectives with preference for acceleration supported by realistic risk mitigation.

3.0 PERFORMANCE OBJECTIVES

The overall performance objective of this SOO is to design, develop, test, implement, and support a solution that provides a reliable web-based cloud automation system to sustain FAA- specific AAC functions. Through Phases 2 and 3 the FAA will engage with participant(s) on the terms and conditions of a production award. The FAA is not restricting flexibility in all elements of business approaches or methods of delivery and deliverables if the conditions comply with applicable laws and regulations and the product best satisfies the FAA's performance requirements and goals.

3.1 Core Objectives

The solution will leverage new technologies and approaches to software development and deployment to further enhance and accelerate the delivery of modern AAC automation capabilities. AAC will employ a new web-based cloud platform that will align with Agency goals and evolutions in the FAA Enterprise Architecture and infrastructure. The new architecture and infrastructure will allow Flight Service activities to scale to projected Alaska air traffic growth. With an architecture designed for flexibility and extensibility, AAC will provide a foundation for future Alaska Flight Service capabilities that will leverage new technologies and operate in a more modernized, interconnected operational and technical environment. In achieving this, AAC will address shortfalls in legacy Flight Service systems related to the current inability of its architecture and hardware to support long-desired, advanced technological features and functions. The new system will execute, at a minimum, the recommendations and enhancements as identified by the Flight Service Program Office (PO).

The three (3) core objectives to meet AAC requirements include:

- a. AAC Automation System Replacement
- b. AAC Automation System Deployment/OASIS Retirement
- c. Additional Baselined System Capabilities

3.1.1 Core Objective 1 – AAC Automation System Replacement

For AAC, the web-based cloud solution will be deployed and will replace the legacy Alaska Flight Service application across all Alaska Flight Service Stations (FSSs). The automation system will be accessible via the internet on the NAS network requiring an integration and deployment plan across all FSSs. The FAA's priority during this step is schedule acceleration.

3.1.2 Core Objective 2 – AAC Automation System Deployment (OASIS Retirement)

For AAC, the web-based cloud solution will be deployed and assume all Alaska flight service functions, including pilot briefings, flight plans, inflight advisory services, search and rescue initiation, aircraft emergencies and NOTAM. The legacy OASIS application will be retired across all Alaska FSSs.

3.1.3 Core Objective 3 – Additional Baselined System Capabilities

This third objective, subject to change based on advances in technology, will usher in the development and implementation of enhanced capabilities across Flight Service functional areas. AAC seeks to integrate new and emerging technologies, where applicable, to meet the Agency's requirements and standardize the services provided in Alaska, leveraging technological advancements to improve air traffic services for general aviation pilots. Additional capabilities will be prioritized based on operational value, enterprise alignment, and technical feasibility.

3.2 Technical Objectives

To meet the overall requirements of this SOO, the Respondent's solution must execute the technical objectives identified in the table below:

Core Objective#	Technical Objective #	Technical Objective Description
Core Objective 1 – AAC Automation System Replacement	1	Define software development and testing processes that conform to modern industry standards and FAA guidance.
	2	Design, develop, test, and support Flight Service and cloud supporting services via a new automation platform.
	3	Design, develop, test, and support AAC interfaces.
	4	Deploy automation system across all Alaska Flight Service Stations, with access to AAC services through a web-based, cloud architecture, based on operational requirements.
	5	Describe testing and training environment for AAC Users.
	6	Develop and conduct training for AAC Users.
	7	Describe customer and site support for AAC Users.
Core Objective 2 – AAC Automation System Deployment (OASIS Retirement)	8	Describe cutover process from OASIS to AAC.
	10	Describe cutover process from OASIS to AAC.
	11	Deploy automation system across all Alaska Flight Service Stations, with access to AAC services through a web-based, cloud architecture, based on operational requirements.
	12	Update training and customer support documentation to address AAC capabilities.
	13	Update and maintain modernized automation web solution.
	14	Leverage new and emerging technologies to meet the FAA requirements.

4.0 CONSTRAINTS AND REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Operating Constraints

Operating constraints will be determined upon production award.

4.2 Technical Requirements Documents

When working on its solution, the Respondent must take into consideration the specifications identified in the following documents found in the Attachments:

- a. Attachment 2, AAC Automation Requirements Document*
- b. Attachment 3, FAA Orders and Policies*

Those documents identified with an * contain system, service, or policy requirements.

4.3 Security Constraints

The Respondent's solution must demonstrate alignment with FAA cybersecurity policies, including Zero Trust architecture principles and applicable cloud authorization requirements. The Respondent must comply with all applicable security regulations, directives, and requirements throughout the entire performance of the production award. Additionally, the Respondent must perform the requirements of the production award in a manner that aligns with evolving security industry best practices.

5.0 PERFORMANCE MEASURES

The following performance measures will inform the determination of whether the identified objectives are met successfully:

- a. Service Availability
- b. Service Continuity
- c. Usability
- d. Schedule

Additional performance measures may be developed and included prior to production award. Previously approved performance measures may be adjusted during the period of performance.

6.0 GOVERNMENT-FURNISHED ITEMS (GFI)

The Government will furnish required computers, monitors, and peripherals necessary to access the AAC web-based cloud solution.

7.0 ACRONYMS

Acronym	Definition
AAC	Alaska Automation Capability
BNATCS	Brand New Air Traffic Control System
ChBA	Challenge-Based Acquisition
CPC	Certified Professional Controller
DOT	Department of Transportation
FAA	Federal Aviation Administration
FSS	Flight Service Station
GFI	Government Furnished Items
NAS	National Airspace System
NOTAM	Notice to Airmen
OASIS	Operational and Supportability Implementation System
PO	Program Office
SAR	Search and Rescue
SOO	Statement of Objectives